Hypertension Practice Guideline

1. Diagnosis

Hypertension is diagnosed when clinic blood pressure stays at or above 140/90 mmHg on repeat visits. Home or ambulatory readings should be used to confirm the diagnosis whenever possible.

2. First line treatment

Start with lifestyle advice for every patient. Reduce salt, keep a healthy weight, be active and limit alcohol. If drugs are needed, an ACE inhibitor or a calcium channel blocker is the usual first choice.

3. Follow up

Review the patient every four weeks until blood pressure is controlled, then every six months. Check kidney function and potassium after starting or changing an ACE inhibitor.